

Friday, 24 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 20°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

26° 15°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

22° 16°

GLASGOW

Light drizzle

18° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Greater Manchester Police have apologised after failing to check the phones of a synagogue attacker, despite arresting him twice before the incident.

Jihad Al-Shamie carried out the attack, and now an investigation has revealed his devices were not reviewed. The force says it deeply regrets the oversight.

CRIME · UK

2

A police officer has been exposed as a violent rapist, with detectives uncovering nine victims so far over a 14-year period.

PC Alan Greer's horrific crimes are now coming to light, and police anticipate many more victims will be identified. The BBC's investigation reveals the shocking extent of his abuse.

CRIME · UK

3

If you're dropping someone off at the airport this summer, prepare for a shock, as drop-off fees have soared by a third.

The cost of parking closest to the terminal has now hit an eye-watering ten pounds at two major UK airports. It's a significant jump for travellers.

TRAVEL · UK

4

A 'life-changing' drug for Multiple Sclerosis, which helps people to walk, is now available on the NHS in England.

Fampridine works by boosting nerve signals, making it easier for those with MS to move around. Up to 5,000 eligible patients could benefit from this treatment.

HEALTH · UK

5

The mother of PC Andrew Harper has spoken out, saying 'every victim will feel the same' about the early release of prisoners.

As the deadline for these releases approaches, new Prime Minister Andy Burnham has reignited the debate, vowing to review the controversial plans.

JUSTICE · UK

What's coming up

1 **Actress Jaime Winstone is the latest celebrity to join the star-studded line-up for this year's Strictly Come Dancing.**

Known for her roles in EastEnders and 'Made in Dagenham', Jaime is the eighth famous face confirmed for the much-anticipated new series. Get ready for some serious sparkle!

ON AIR – Who do you think will be her dance partner, and how do you think she'll fare on the dancefloor?

TV · COMING UP

2 **Congratulations are in order for Love Island: All Stars winners Molly Smith and Tom Clare, who have officially tied the knot!**

The popular couple, who won the first spin-off series of the hit dating show in 2024, have now made it official. It's lovely to see a Love Island romance go the distance.

ON AIR – Do you think reality TV romances can truly last, or are they usually just for the cameras?

CELEBRITY · NOW

3 **DJ Fatboy Slim is helping to save a beloved Brighton music venue, describing it as the 'lifeblood' of the local scene.**

He's among a group of investors, including Prime Minister Andy Burnham, who are stepping in to buy The Pipeline. It's fantastic news for music lovers and local culture.

ON AIR – What's the most important local music venue or cultural spot in your area that you'd hate to see disappear?

MUSIC · NOW

4 **The latest 'Mission Impossible' film is set to take audiences on an ancient odyssey, drawing inspiration from one of the oldest books.**

Director Christopher Nolan was reportedly 'very moved' by holding an ancient copy of the Odyssey. It sounds like a truly epic cinematic experience is on the way!

ON AIR – Which classic story or myth would you love to see given a modern, blockbuster movie adaptation?

FILM · COMING UP

5 **The world's biggest YouTuber, MrBeast, has announced he's married Thea Booyesen, proudly calling her his 'Mrs Beast'.**

The internet sensation, known for his elaborate stunts and giveaways, shared the happy news with his millions of followers. It's a big moment for the online world.

ON AIR – Do you follow any YouTubers, and what kind of content do you enjoy watching online?

CELEBRITY · NOW

On the schedule

- 1 **Tyson Fury is lighter than his opponent for only the fourth time in his career ahead of tonight's heavyweight bout with Mariusz Wach.**
The 'Gypsy King' weighed in less than his rival for the first time in 15 years. It promises to be an intriguing fight in what could be a career first for Fury.
ON AIR – Do you think Tyson Fury being lighter than usual will be an advantage or a disadvantage for him tonight?
BOXING · UK

- 2 **Newcastle United and Liverpool are planning a special tribute to Kevin Keegan before their Premier League opener.**
The two clubs are in talks to honour the legendary player and manager at St James' Park on Sunday, August 23rd. It'll be a fantastic moment for fans of both teams.
ON AIR – Who is your favourite player who has played for both Newcastle and Liverpool, and why?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 3 **Fernando Alonso is 'optimistic' about Aston Martin's major upgrade at the Hungarian Grand Prix, which could influence his future.**
The veteran driver's contract situation has been a hot topic, and a strong performance this weekend could be key. All eyes will be on the Aston Martin garage.
ON AIR – Do you think this upgrade will be enough to secure Alonso's future with Aston Martin, or will he look elsewhere?
F1 · INTERNATIONAL

- 4 **Manchester United's 15-year-old sensation JJ Gabriel has received a senior call-up and could make his debut tonight.**
The talented teenager has been named in the squad for the friendly against Rosenborg. It's an incredible opportunity for such a young player.
ON AIR – At what age do you think a footballer is truly ready to make their senior debut, regardless of talent?
FOOTBALL · UK

- 5 **Phil Salt led Welsh Fire to victory last night, guiding them to a six-wicket win against Southern Brave in a low-scoring Hundred match.**
The captain finished unbeaten on 47, ensuring his team started their campaign with a strong performance. It was a tense opener for both sides.
ON AIR – What do you think is the key to winning low-scoring cricket matches – aggressive batting or disciplined bowling?
CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that 'daydreaming' isn't just idleness, it's actually rather good for us.**
Researchers found that allowing our minds to wander can boost creativity and problem-solving skills. So next time you're staring out the window, tell your boss it's essential brain work!
- 2 The enduring charm of 'vintage board games' is seeing a surprising comeback, with families rediscovering classics.**
Instead of digital screens, many are opting for the tactile joy of dice, cards, and shared laughter around a physical board. Dust off that old 'Monopoly'!
- 3 A recent trend highlights the simple pleasure of 'writing a physical letter' is experiencing a charming resurgence among all age groups.**
It seems there's something uniquely special about receiving a handwritten note in the post, a little tangible piece of connection in our digital world.
- 4 Scientists have discovered that birds in urban areas are adapting their songs to be heard over city noise.**
They're learning to sing at a higher pitch and shorter duration to cut through the hustle and bustle, showing remarkable adaptability in their feathered orchestras.
- 5 The surprising popularity of 'board game cafes' continues to grow across the UK, offering a cosy spot for social gaming.**
These venues provide a relaxed atmosphere where friends and families can gather, grab a snack, and dive into a world of strategic fun away from home.
- 6 Research indicates that 'listening to gentle rain sounds' can significantly improve focus and relaxation.**
The consistent, non-intrusive sound of rainfall creates a 'white noise' effect, helping to mask distracting background sounds and promote a calmer state of mind.
- 7 The delightful art of 'cloud-gazing' is quietly making a comeback as a soothing pastime for all ages.**
Taking a moment to observe the ever-changing shapes in the sky offers a simple, mindful escape from daily stresses, sparking imagination and a sense of wonder.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to decide if we've left the oven on, even though we know we checked it?

ANSWER: GOING BACK TO THE KITCHEN JUST 'ONE MORE TIME' FOR A QUICK PEEK.

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down for a good night's sleep. What is it?

ANSWER: LINING UP ALL THEIR SHOES PERFECTLY STRAIGHT BY THE BED.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden detail' in a place you visit all the time, and it makes you look at it completely differently?

Perhaps it's a carving you never noticed on a familiar building, or a quirky feature in your local park. What surprising 'hidden details' have you stumbled upon in your everyday world?

- Think about those 'everyday objects' that you've surprisingly had for an incredibly long time, almost like an old friend.

It could be a favourite mug, a well-worn gardening glove, or even a trusty pen. What 'everyday object' has been with you through thick and thin, and what makes it so special?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Nature.** Did you know that the 'smell of rain' actually has a name? It's called 'petrichor', and it's caused by an oil released from certain plants combined with a chemical produced by soil bacteria.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Northern Lights, or Aurora Borealis, can sometimes be heard as a faint crackling sound, like static electricity, by people directly underneath them.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£3.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest complete English sentence is 'I am'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's largest hot desert is the Sahara Desert, which covers over 9.2 million square kilometres.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- The highest mountain in the British Isles is Ben Nevis in Scotland, standing at 1,345 metres.
- A group of porcupines is called a prickly.
- The distinctive smell of old books is called 'bibliosmia'.

On this day

Day 205 of the year, 160 days left in 2026. Today Carnival of Awussu (Tunisia); Children's Day (Vanuatu); Christian feast day: Charbel (Maronite Church/Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Christina the Astonishing. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1951 — Lynda Carter, American actress
- 1949 — Michael Richards, American actor and comedian
- 1936 — Mark Goddard, American actor (died 2023)
- 1942 — David Miner, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1952 — Gus Van Sant, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1971 — Patty Jenkins, American film director and screenwriter
- 1966 — Martin Keown, English footballer and coach
- 1973 — Amanda Stretton, English racing driver and journalist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1987 — US supertanker SS Bridgeton collides with mines laid by IRGC causing a 43-square-meter dent in the body of the oil tanker.
- 1982 — Heavy rain causes a mudslide that destroys a bridge at Nagasaki, Japan, killing 299.
- 1943 — World War II: Operation Gomorrah begins: British and Canadian aeroplanes bomb Hamburg by night, and American planes bomb the city by day. By the end of the operation in November, 9,000 tons of explosives will have killed more than 30,000 people and destroyed 280,000 buildings.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2001 — The Bandaranaike Airport attack is carried out by 14 Tamil Tiger commandos, resulting in military and civilian casualties and destroyed aircraft.
- 1999 — Air Fiji flight 121 crashes while en route to Nadi, Fiji, killing all 17 people on board.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1967 — During an official state visit to Canada, French President Charles de Gaulle declares to a crowd of over 100,000 in Montreal: Vive le Québec libre! ("Long live free Quebec!"); the statement angered the Canadian government and many Anglophone Canadians.

- 1929 — The Kellogg–Briand Pact, renouncing war as an instrument of foreign policy, goes into effect (it is first signed in Paris on August 27, 1928, by most leading world powers).
- 2012 — Syrian civil war: The People's Protection Units (YPG) capture the city of Girkê Legê.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 206 of the year, 159 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anne (Eastern Christianity); Christian feast day: Carmen Salles y Barangueras; Christian feast day: Christopher (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Cucuphas. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1991 — Toni Duggan, English footballer
- 1965 — Marty Brown, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1969 — D. B. Woodside, American actor
- 1971 — Roger Creager, American singer-songwriter
- 1979 — Ali Carter, English snooker player
- 1966 — Maureen Herman, American bass player
- 1967 — Matt LeBlanc, American actor and producer
- 1958 — Thurston Moore, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1984 — Salyut 7 cosmonaut Svetlana Savitskaya becomes the first woman to perform a space walk.
- 1971 — The Sohagpur massacre is perpetrated by the Pakistan Army.
- 1993 — Israel launches a massive attack against Lebanon in what the Israelis call Operation Accountability, and the Lebanese call the Seven-Day War.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2019 — National extreme heat records set this day in the UK, Belgium, The Netherlands and Germany during the July 2019 European heat wave.
- 1993 — The Saint James Church massacre occurs in Kenilworth, Cape Town, South Africa.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)